

SECTION C : APIs, Tools & Developer Concepts.

19. Application Programming Interface (API)

Act as digital messengers, allowing different software applications to talk to one another behind the scenes. Without them, every app would have to be built entirely from scratch.

Example • Uber eats, ordering food through this platform triggers chain of APIs working in sequence. One API loads the restaurant menu, a Payment API charges the card, a Geolocation API tracks the driver and a Push Notification API alerts when the food arrives. APIs are important because they act as standard bridges that let different programs talk to and share data with each other.

20 API key is a unique identifier used to authenticate software and systems attempting to access other software systems via an API. They are useful aspect of API security as they help organization monitor calls to APIs and manage API consumption. Increasing security and ensuring that these programs have adequate bandwidth.

To store API key for production applications, dedicated secrets management systems are considered the best option for storing API keys. For development applications, a dev. file provides a simple universal supported storage solution. It is generally advised that separate keys be used for production and development and that API keys should never be put in source code. A leaked API key can enable quick unauthorized access to your API and can lead to unauthorized usage, data exposure, service abuse, reputational damage.